



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Resources of an Information System



Learning Outcome:

Identify key information about people's jobs and places of work in spoken or written contexts.

Design the data structure, starting from the conceptual model determined in the systems analysis, using database IT tools, according to regulation and established standards.

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about people resources in information systems.
- I can give examples of software resources in information systems.
- I can give examples of hardware resources in information systems.

Ask your partner:

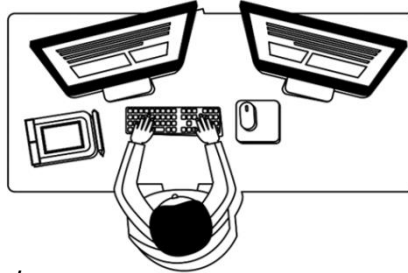
- Does your company have adequate and enough resources for its information system – people, data, software, hardware, networks? Why? Why not?
- What operating systems do you know? Does your company work on projects using them?





Let's Explore!

An experienced worker is talking to a new employee in the IT department about his experience with information systems.



Instructions: Read the text below.

- Anderson:** We were working really hard this time a month ago on a new information system, remember?
- John:** Yeah. I remember that while I was working with the technical staff on installing the networks, you and the other testers were checking the printers and computers' functioning. Once you finished, Caroline and Isabella, our programmers, were writing codes and instructions to customize the mainframes, laptops, and desktops.
- Anderson:** Uh-huh. At 6 pm that day, I recall that Caroline was doing the programming of most computers when Jack, the systems analyst, told her to stop all her work. This happened because all of a sudden the client changed the requirements and everything would need to be redone.
- John:** Ohh yeah! But, why was she doing the wrong things during the installation process? She was almost finishing her work when she was told to stop it.
- Anderson:** As far as I know, the mistake was so big that the chief information officer terminated Jack's contract after investigating that the failure happened because of him and not the client's.
- John:** Poor Jack.
- Anderson:** I know, right? You know what I liked about that project, its software resources. The multi-user and multitasking operating systems controlling the mainframes were amazing. Besides, most of the desktops and laptops needed special application software packages to be installed for the huge number of transactions that the company handles. I learned a lot from that project.
- John:** Well, what I liked the most was all the hardware we installed. I really enjoy my job when there are a lot of technological resources involved. For example, resources like laser printers, photocopiers, laptops, desktops, mainframes, routers, scanners, LED TVs, video screens, wireless projector screens, overhead projectors, and interactive whiteboards. Even smartphones! I remember that while I was helping to install software in several notebooks, some people asked me to sync their smartphones with their office PCs.

**Let's Practice!**

I like having new hardware in my office.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. John / lot / there / technological / / a / resources. / enjoys / when / of / are
2. installs / every / / years. / two / new / hardware / John
3. smartphone / John / synch / people / PCs. / helps / / their / with / their

**Let's Practice!**

We were working hard!

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to complete each sentence. You can use the words more than once.

Word Bank

when / how / who / while / what / why

I had some problems last week at my job. First of all, I was working with the technical staff _____ the testers were checking part of the hardware all morning. Second, the programmers were late _____ they were writing codes and instructions to customize laptops. Finally, Caroline was programing some computers _____ I told her to stop.



Extension Activity

What were you doing while you were using the information system?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search for experiences people had while using information systems.
- Based on those, think about experiences that happened to you while you were using an information system.
- Write down a paragraph about your experience(s).
- Share your paragraph with the class and discuss.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I search for experiences people had while using information systems.
- I think about experiences that happened to me while I was using an information system.
- I write down a paragraph about my experience(s).
- I share and discuss information related to experiences with information systems.

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Target Words

- **technical staff** (noun): employees that are able to apply scientific knowledge to repair, maintain, install, program, or modify machines and equipment
e.g. I remember that while I was working with the technical staff on installing the networks, you and the other testers were checking the printers and computers' functioning.
- **testers** (noun): employees in an IT department in charge of checking software and hardware's functioning
e.g. I remember that while I was working with the technical staff on installing the networks, you and the other testers were checking the printers and computers' functioning.
- **notebook** (noun): a notebook is another name given to a laptop
e.g. Even smartphones. I remember that while I was helping to install software in some notebooks, some people asked me to synch their smartphones with their office PCs.
- **redo** (verb): to do again, to start again
e.g. At 6 pm that day, I recall Caroline was doing the programming of most computers, when Jack, the systems analyst, told her to stop all her work because of a sudden change in the client's requirements and everything would need to be redone.
- **interactive whiteboard** (noun): an interactive screen connected to a computer
e.g. I really enjoy when there are a lot of technological resources involved, for example, laser printers, photocopiers, laptops, desktops, mainframes, routers, scanners, LED TVs, video screens, wireless projector screens, overhead projectors and interactive whiteboards.
- **recall** (verb): to remember
e.g. At 6 pm that day, I recall Caroline was doing the programming of most computers, when Jack, the systems analyst, told her to stop all her work.



Learning Points

Time Expressions in Past Continuous in Affirmative, Negative, and Questions

The **past continuous** tense refers to actions that were happening for some time in the past and then finished.

Functions

The **past continuous** tense is used to explain:

- an action happening at a specific point of time in the past.
- an action that was happening during some time in the past.
- an action that was happening when something important took place.





Learning Points

Time expressions in the Past Continuous tense

There are many *time expressions* associated to the **past continuous** tense. Depending on the function, a *time expression* is more suitable than other. Let's take a look at some of these time expressions:

As,

While,

This time yesterday, this time last year, etc.

All last night, all last week, all last month, etc.

Between ... and ... yesterday, between ... and ... last year, etc.

At noon yesterday, at midnight the day before yesterday, etc.

During the whole night, during the break time, etc.

.... when

Examples:

- **As** Kathie **was testing** the software, I **was reviewing** the protocol to install the network system.
- **While** Kathie **was testing** the software, I **was reviewing** the protocol to install the network system.
- We **were setting up** the office equipment, notebooks, printers and projectors **all last night**.
- **Between 9 am and 10 pm yesterday**, we **were working** on programming the new desktops and notebooks that came to the company.
- Sandy **was installing** the communications network **when** suddenly a short circuit happened in one of the modules she **was working on** during the whole morning.

Examples

- We were working really hard this time a month ago on a new information system, remember?
- I remember that while I was working with the technical staff on installing the networks, you and the other testers were checking the printers and computers' functioning. Caroline was doing the programming of most computers when Jack, the systems analyst, told her to stop all her work.





Learning Points

Computer Metaphors

In the world of computers, there are some singular words which they may seem like any other but, in fact, they have different meanings.

Bus: Like a passenger bus, a databus is a tool that helps data to travel every day by going and coming back to the same point. A databus uses a circuitry similar to a bus that helps people to commute.

Window: Just like when you see the world through a room's window, a program window let users see what's going on in that program.

Frame: Like a photograph camera, frames compartmentalize screen space and help to individualize space and concepts.

Desktop: A visual surface can be similar to a panoramic. It is a generic physical surface where the most important elements are found.

Open/Close: Program windows, the programs themselves and ports need to be opened or closed to reach a particular goal.

File: Data occupies space and a useful way to pack it is in a file. Such data can be modified, stored, or retrieve.

Folder: A folder is a cluster of files of the same or different types.

